

PHISHING AWARENESS AND CYBERSECURITY TRAINING

Protect Yourself from Cyber Threats



WHAT IS PHISHING?

Phishing is a cyberattack designed to trick individuals into revealing sensitive information. Attackers pose as trustworthy entities to deceive victims into providing credentials, financial details, or personal data. These malicious tactics are used for credential theft, financial fraud, and malware infection.

- ✓ Stealing login credentials and passwords
- ✓ Committing financial fraud and identity theft
- ✓ Installing malware on your devices
- ✓ Gaining unauthorized access to systems





Suspicious Senders

Check the sender's email address carefully. Attackers often use addresses that look similar to legitimate ones but contain subtle misspellings or use free email domains.



Poor Grammar

Professional communications are carefully proofread. Watch for spelling errors, awkward phrasing, or inconsistent formatting that may indicate a fraudulent message.



Unexpected Links

Be wary of unexpected attachments or links from unknown senders. Hover over links before clicking to preview the actual destination URL.



Urgent Language

Phishing emails often create a false sense of urgency with phrases like "immediate action required" or threats of account suspension to pressure quick responses.



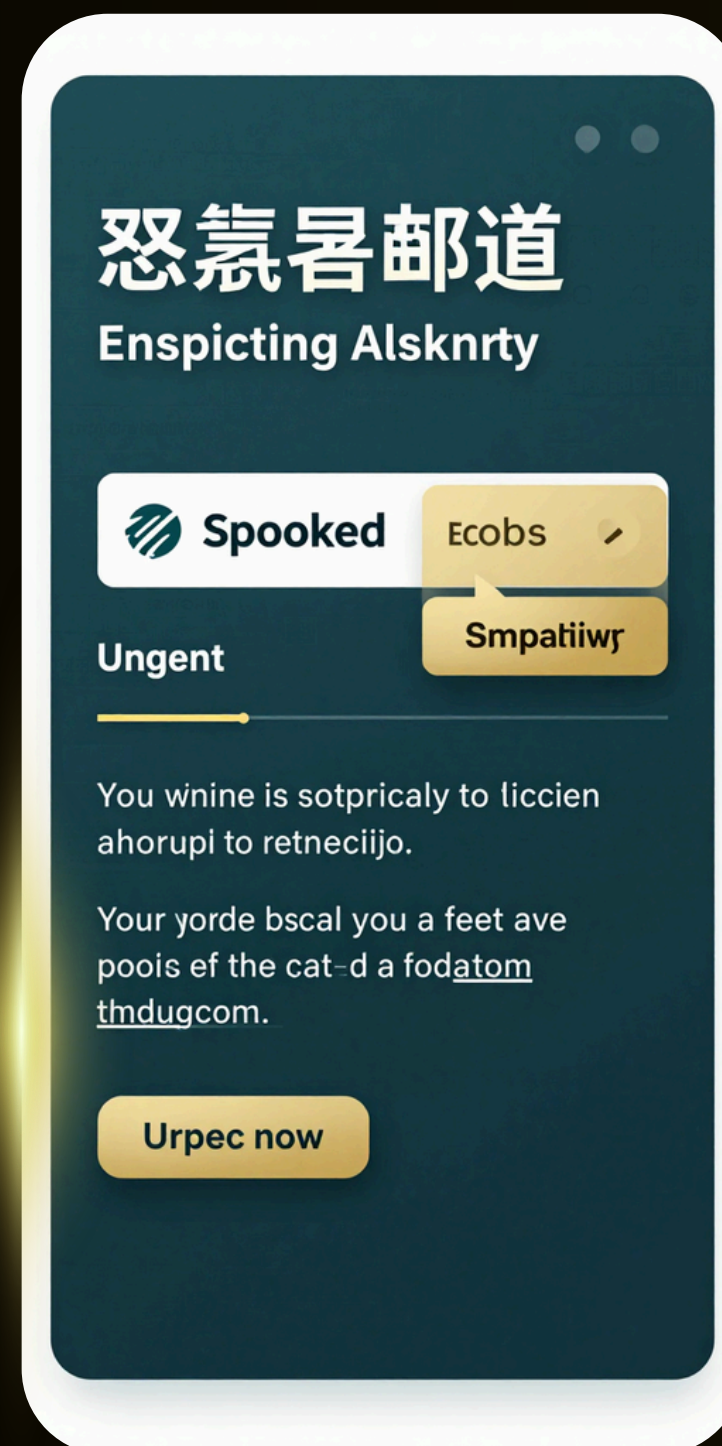
KEY PHISHING EMAIL INDICATORS

Being able to recognize phishing emails is your first line of defense against cyber attacks. Always examine emails carefully before clicking links or opening attachments. When in doubt, verify with the sender through a separate communication channel.

SAMPLE EMAIL PHISHING ANALYSIS

This sample phishing email contains multiple red flags. Notice the sender address appears to be from a legitimate company but has slight spelling variations. The subject line uses urgent language to create panic and bypass critical thinking.

The email body contains grammatical errors and requests immediate action. Links appear to lead to the legitimate company but redirect to fraudulent sites. Always verify sender addresses and hover over links before clicking.



✓ Suspicious Sender

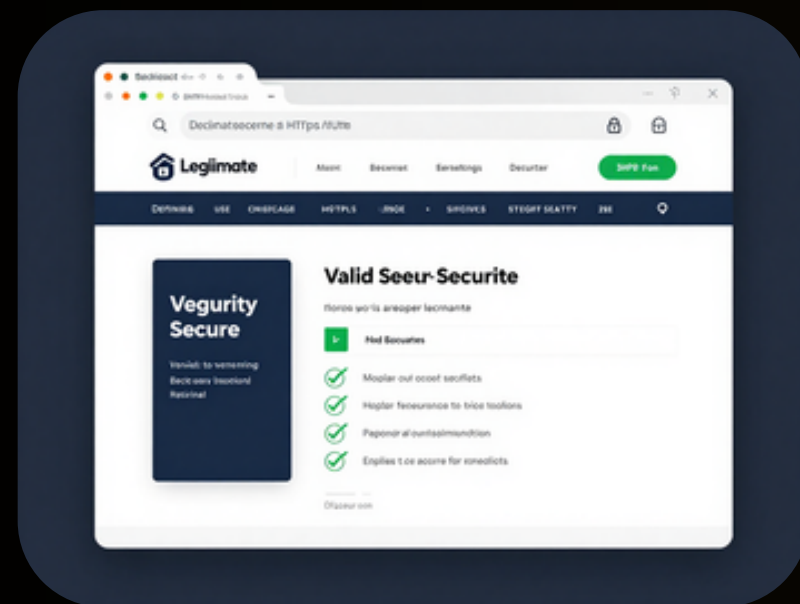
Look for misspelled or unusual sender addresses. Attackers often spoof legitimate company names to gain trust.

✓ Urgent & Threatening

Phishing emails use urgent language like "immediate action required" or threats to create panic and bypass your critical thinking.



REAL VS FAKE COMPARISON



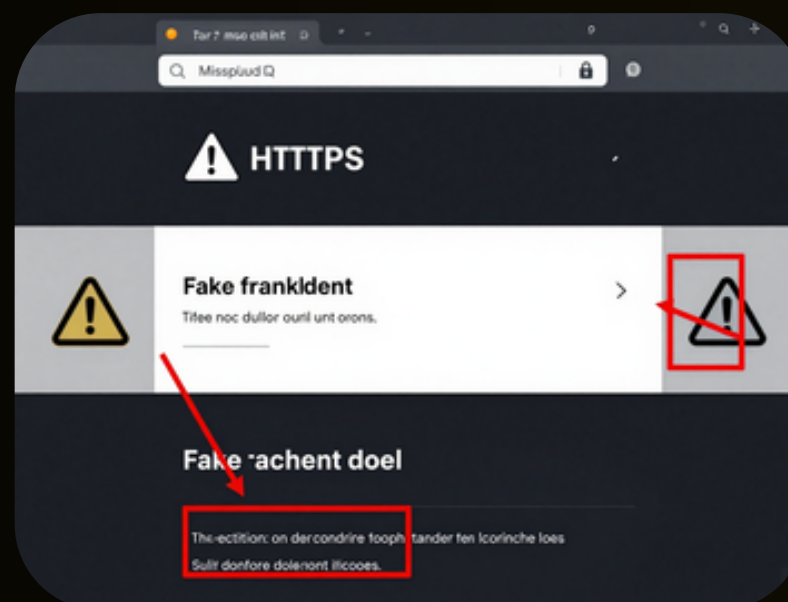
✓ Legitimate Website Example

Real website: Proper URL with HTTPS encryption. Consistent branding, professional design, and valid security certificate displayed.



Fake Website Example

Fake website: Notice the misspelled domain name and lack of HTTPS. The design is inconsistent with the legitimate site branding.



When comparing websites, always check the URL carefully for misspellings or unusual domain extensions. Look for HTTPS and valid security certificates. Fake sites often have poor design quality, inconsistent branding, and broken links. Real websites maintain consistent visual elements and proper security indicators.



✓ Pretexting

Fabricating a believable scenario to gain your trust and extract information. Attackers create elaborate stories to appear legitimate.

✓ Impersonation

Pretending to be a trusted figure like IT support, a manager, or a bank representative to gain access to systems or information.

✓ Quid Pro Quo

Offering a service or favor in exchange for information. Common in tech support scams where help is offered for credentials.

✓ Baiting

Offering something enticing like free downloads or USB drives to lure victims. The temptation triggers curiosity and bypasses caution.



SOCIAL ENGINEERING TACTICS

Attackers use psychological manipulation to trick victims into revealing sensitive information. Understanding these tactics helps you recognize when someone is trying to manipulate you for malicious purposes.

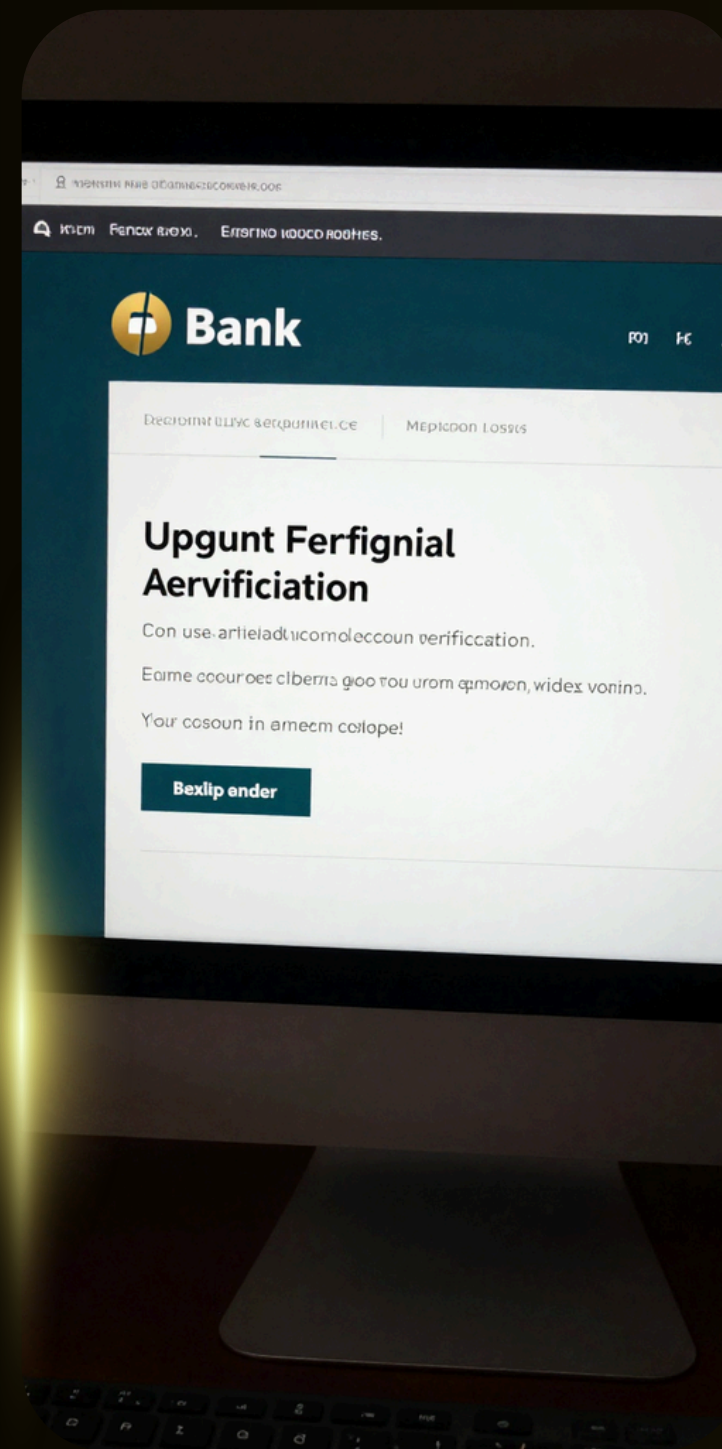
PRACTICAL

EXERCISE 1

SPOT THE PHISHING EMAIL

Below is a sample email containing multiple suspicious elements. Use the checklist on the right to identify each phishing indicator. Take a moment to analyze the email carefully before moving on.

After completing the checklist, discuss your findings with your team. Compare answers and explain why each element is suspicious. This hands-on practice helps build the skills needed to recognize real phishing attempts.



Identify 5 Red Flags

Check for: suspicious sender address, urgent language, poor grammar, unexpected attachments, and suspicious links.



Mark Each Indicator

Circle or highlight each suspicious element in the email. The more you practice, the easier it becomes to spot phishing attempts.

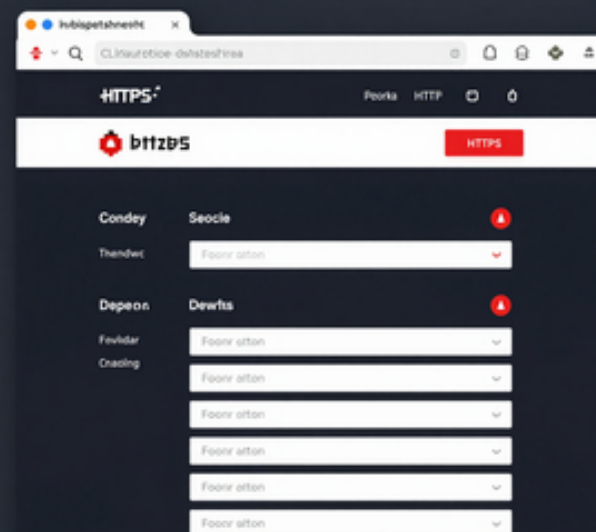


✓ Real Website

This is the REAL website. Notice the clean URL, HTTPS security indicator, and professional design.

✓ Fake Website

This is the FAKE website. Notice the misspelled URL, missing security certificate, and poor design quality.



SPOT THE FAKE WEBSITE

Take a close look at both websites. Which one looks fake? Check the URL for misspellings or unusual domains. Look for HTTPS and valid security certificates. Notice any poor design, inconsistent branding, or broken links. Discuss with your team what clues helped you identify the fake site.



✓ **Verify Sender**

Always verify the sender's email address before clicking links or opening attachments. Look for subtle misspellings or unusual domain names that may indicate a fake sender.

✓ **Update Software**

Keep your operating system, applications, and antivirus software up to date. Security patches protect against known vulnerabilities that attackers exploit.

✓ **Strong Passwords**

Use strong, unique passwords for each account. Consider using a password manager to generate and store complex passwords securely.

✓ **Enable MFA**

Enable multi-factor authentication (MFA) on all your accounts. This adds an extra layer of security beyond passwords, making it much harder for attackers to gain access.



ONLINE PREVENTION SAFETY

Protecting yourself from phishing attacks starts with simple, consistent practices. By following these essential prevention tips, you can significantly reduce your risk of falling victim to cyber threats. Stay vigilant, think before you click, and make security a daily habit.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE 1

In 2024, a major Fortune 500 company fell victim to a sophisticated phishing attack. An employee received an email appearing to be from a trusted vendor, requesting urgent payment information. The attacker successfully compromised the system, leading to significant consequences.

- ✓ Data breach affecting over 500,000 customer records
- ✓ Financial loss exceeding \$50 million in damages
- ✓ Severe reputational damage and lost customer trust
- ✓ Regulatory fines and ongoing legal consequences



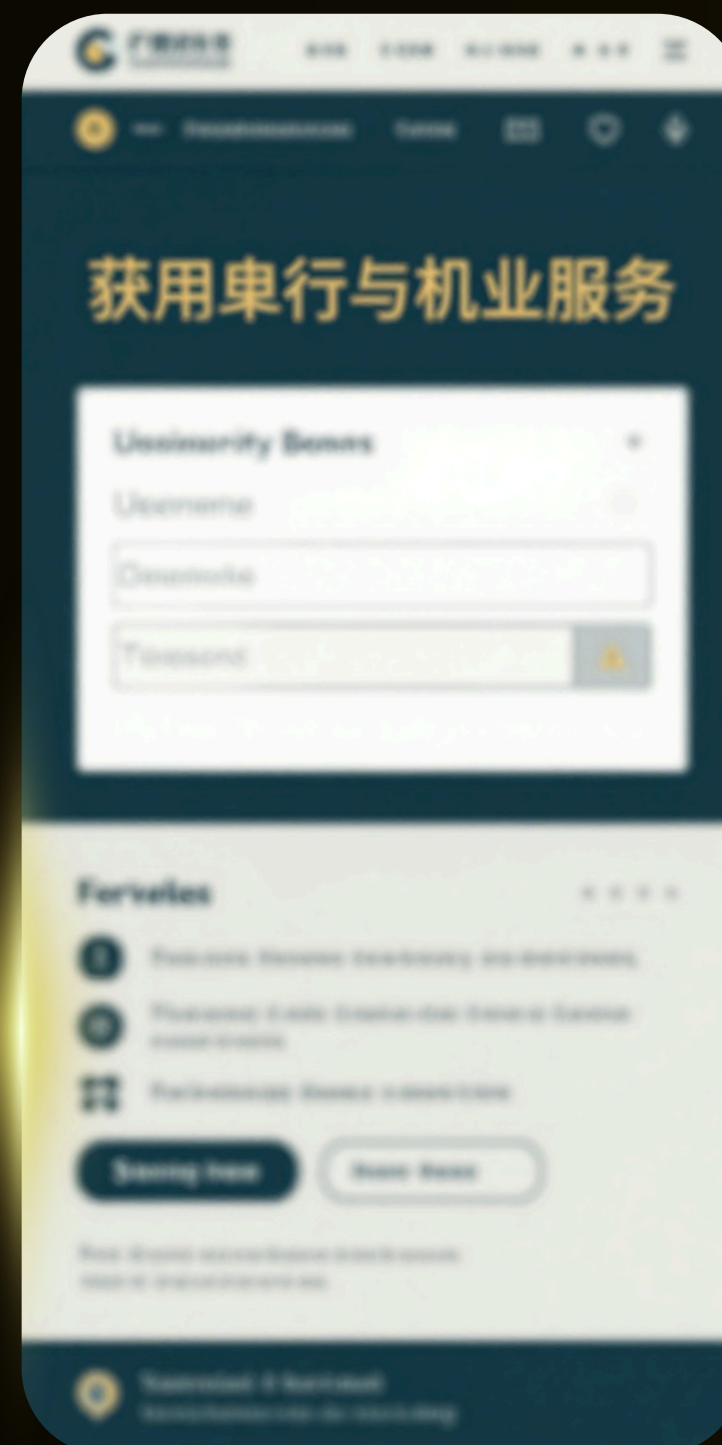
REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

FAKE BANKING

WEBSITE

A criminal group created a convincing replica of a legitimate bank's login page. The fake site used identical branding, logos, and layout to trick users into entering their credentials.

Over 50,000 users unknowingly entered their username, password, and account details into the fraudulent site. Many victims suffered financial losses, unauthorized transfers, and identity theft.



Always verify the URL

Check for HTTPS and valid security certificates. Even small URL differences can indicate a fake site designed to steal your credentials.



Bookmark official sites

Never click bank links from emails or messages. Always navigate directly to official banking websites by typing the URL yourself.

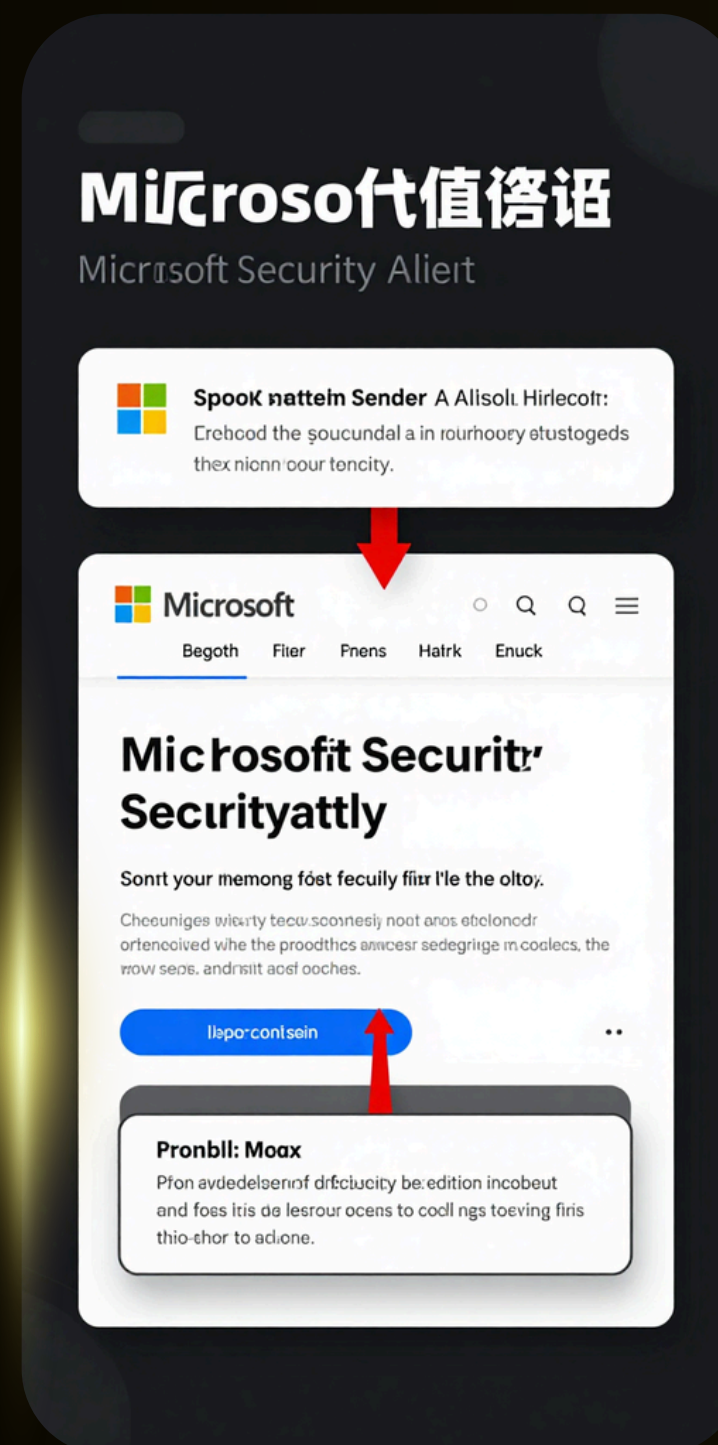
REAL-WORLD

EXAMPLE 3 —

MICROSOFT PHISHING EMAIL

This phishing email pretends to be from Microsoft, targeting users with urgent language about account security. Attackers use spoofed Microsoft branding and logos to appear legitimate and gain trust.

Even trusted brands can be faked. Always verify sender email addresses, check for suspicious links before clicking, and never enter credentials in response to unexpected emails claiming urgent action is needed.



Suspicious Links

Links redirect to fake login pages that look identical to Microsoft sites but capture your credentials when entered.



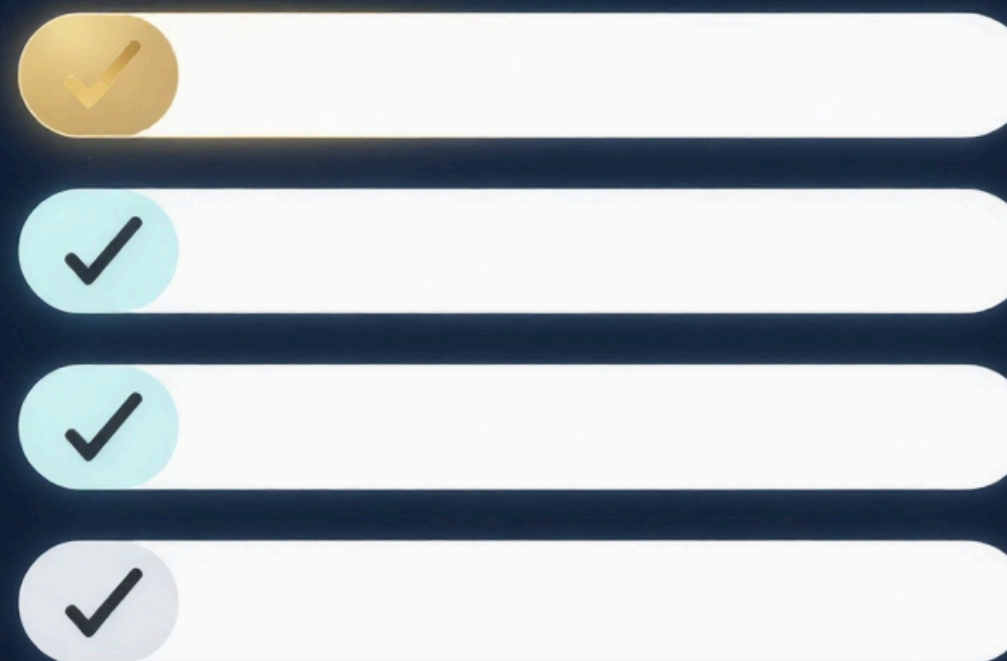
Spoofed Branding

Attackers copy Microsoft logos and design elements to appear authentic. The sender address often contains subtle misspellings.

INTERACTIVE QUIZ

Test your phishing awareness knowledge with these questions. Choose the best answer for each question. Take your time and think carefully about what you've learned in this training session.

- ✓ Which is NOT a common phishing email indicator?
- ✓ True or False: Emails from unknown senders are always phishing.
- ✓ What is the safest response to a suspicious email?

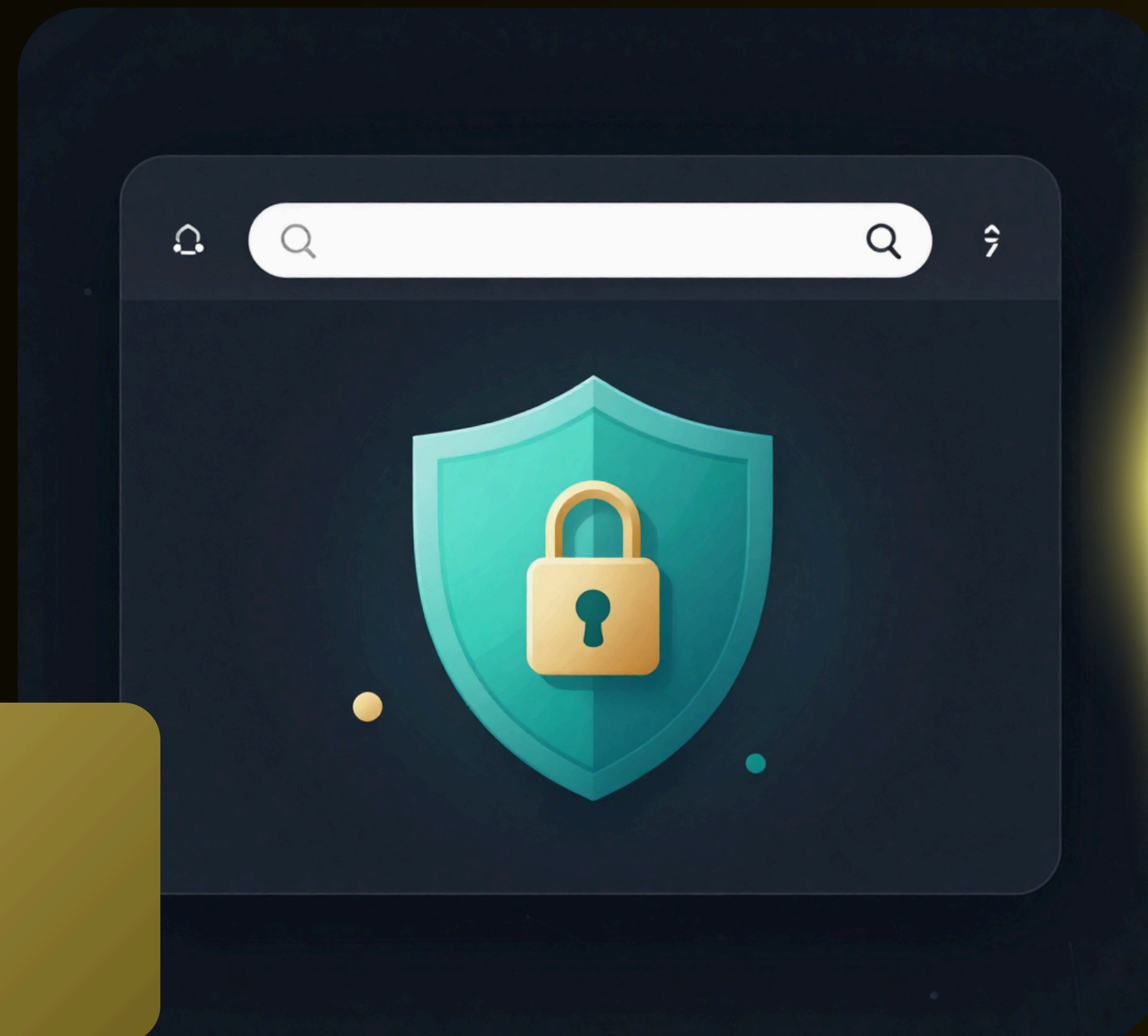




INTERACTIVE QUIZ — QUESTIONS SET 2

Test your knowledge of identifying fake websites and safe browsing practices. Select the best answer for each question. Take your time to think through each scenario carefully.

- ✓ What should you check to verify a website's legitimacy?
- ✓ Which of the following URL patterns is most suspicious?
- ✓ What is the BEST response when a website asks for sensitive data unexpectedly?
- ✓ True or False: A website with HTTPS is always safe and legitimate.





Cybersecurity Team

THANK YOU FOR YOUR ATTENTION



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